

Wellness Wednesday *talking points*

Wellness Wednesday is a five-minute nod, not a course. One page per month: the idea to share, one thing people can try that day, a quick recap of Monday and Tuesday, and what is coming Thursday and at the in-person workshop. Post it, read it at the top of a meeting, or paste it into a channel.

M1 OCTOBER 2026 · WELLNESS WEDNESDAY

Speaking up about what you are good at

This month's theme: See the Talent Around You

SAY THIS

- Talking about your own strengths at work is uncomfortable for most people, and staying quiet about them is a quiet cost: the work you would be best at goes to whoever mentioned it first.
- Psychological safety is what makes that conversation possible. It is not comfort or agreement; it is the belief that naming a skill, a gap or a mistake will not be held against you.
- You do not need a program for it. You need one honest sentence in one conversation this week.

One thing to try: Say one true sentence about your own work out loud this week: something you are good at, or something you want help with.

WHERE WE HAVE BEEN THIS WEEK

- **Monday** (managers) covered **The Talent Read**: Reading your team's skills, gaps, and flight risk [recap or catch up](#)
- **Tuesday** (all staff) covered **On the Map**: The Talent Marketplace: what it shows and how to use it [recap or catch up](#)

WHAT IS COMING

- **Thursday** brings **The Better Question**: Softskill · Curiosity: asking better career questions [details and sign-up](#)
- **The in-person workshop** this month is **The Talent Map Lab**, 90 minutes with a navigator, hands on in the room. Watch your invite for the date. Sign up: [\[sign-up link\]](#)

Belonging travels with you

This month's theme: The Transfer Portal in Practice

SAY THIS

- An internal move is exciting and unsettling at once. People leave a team where they knew everyone's shorthand and arrive somewhere they have to earn it again.
- Belonging is rebuilt through small repeated contact, not a welcome lunch. Movers should expect a few awkward weeks and plan for them.
- The people who stay behind feel it too. A teammate leaving well is not a rejection of the team, and saying so out loud helps.

One thing to try: If someone near you is moving, ask what they want to keep from this team. If someone new arrived, invite them to one thing this week.

WHERE WE HAVE BEEN THIS WEEK

- **Monday** (managers) covered **The Sending Manager**: Being a sending manager: releasing talent well [recap or catch up](#)
- **Tuesday** (all staff) covered **The Open Door**: Navigating the Transfer Portal, end to end [recap or catch up](#)

WHAT IS COMING

- **Thursday** brings **Internal Bridges**: Networking without the ick: building internal bridges [details and sign-up](#)
- **The in-person workshop** this month is **The Profile Clinic**, 90 minutes with a navigator, hands on in the room. Watch your invite for the date. Sign up: [\[sign-up link\]](#)

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DECEMBER 2026 · WELLNESS WEDNESDAY

Pace is a leadership behavior

This month's theme: The Vanderbilt Manager Standard

SAY THIS

- Teams copy the pace they see. A leader who sends messages at midnight teaches the team that midnight is when work happens, whatever the policy says.
- Sustainable pace is not doing less. It is being deliberate about when work is visible, so recovery time is real rather than theoretical.
- This month is about observable behaviors. Pace is one of the most observable of all.

One thing to try: Pick one boundary you can make visible this week: a scheduled send, a real lunch, or a meeting that ends on time.

WHERE WE HAVE BEEN THIS WEEK

- **Monday** (managers) covered **The Standard**: Unpacking the manager standard: the observable behaviors [recap or catch up](#)
- **Tuesday** (all staff) covered **Own Your 1:1**: The 1:1 templates and feedback tools inside Oracle, from your side of the table [recap or catch up](#)

WHAT IS COMING

- **Thursday** brings **Clarity That Sticks**: Clarity as a two-way skill: ask, restate, and close the loop in writing [details and sign-up](#)
- **The in-person workshop** this month is **The Standard Walk**, 90 minutes with a navigator, hands on in the room. Watch your invite for the date. Sign up: [\[sign-up link\]](#)

Cognitive load, and when to put something down

This month's theme: AI at Work: Start Where You Are

SAY THIS

- Every new tool costs attention before it saves any. That cost is real and temporary, and it is worth naming rather than pretending it away.
- The point of handing a chore to a tool is not to fill the time with more chores. It is to have more attention left for the work only you can do.
- Notice what you are actually spending recovered time on. If it is more low-value work, the tool did not help.

One thing to try: After you save time with any tool this week, name where that time went. If the answer is nothing good, choose differently next time.

WHERE WE HAVE BEEN THIS WEEK

- **Monday** (managers) covered **Set the Tone:** Framing AI as a leadership responsibility [recap or catch up](#)
- **Tuesday** (all staff) covered **Your First Win:** Hands-on: one safe AI use case for your daily work [recap or catch up](#)

WHAT IS COMING

- **Thursday** brings **Steady in the Fog:** Softskill · Adaptability: leading through ambiguity [details and sign-up](#)
- **The in-person workshop** this month is **The Sandbox**, 90 minutes with a navigator, hands on in the room. Watch your invite for the date. Sign up: [\[sign-up link\]](#)

Growth is a wellbeing question

This month's theme: Retain, Grow, Move

SAY THIS

- People rarely describe career stagnation as a wellbeing problem, but it behaves like one: low energy, less initiative, a slow pull away from work that used to matter.
- Growth does not have to mean promotion. A new skill, a different project, or a clearer path is often enough to change how the week feels.
- Asking for growth is not disloyalty. Managers hearing the ask is how people stay.

One thing to try: Name one thing you want to be better at a year from now, and tell one person who could help.

WHERE WE HAVE BEEN THIS WEEK

- **Monday** (managers) covered **The Bench**: Succession conversations that don't scare people [recap or catch up](#)
- **Tuesday** (all staff) covered **Your Next Move**: Using the Talent Marketplace and the Transfer Portal to plan your own growth and next internal move [recap or catch up](#)

WHAT IS COMING

- **Thursday** brings **The Sponsor**: Advocacy: mentors give you advice, sponsors spend their credibility on you [details and sign-up](#)
- **The in-person workshop** this month is **The Stay Lab**, 90 minutes with a navigator, hands on in the room. Watch your invite for the date. Sign up: [\[sign-up link\]](#)

Listening lowers the load on both sides

This month's theme: Coaching as the Core Manager Behavior

SAY THIS

- Being genuinely listened to reduces the pressure of a problem even when nothing about the problem changes. That is why a good conversation can leave you lighter.
- It works in both directions. Listening without preparing your reply is less effortful than performing attention while planning what to say.
- Most of the skill is restraint: fewer interruptions, one honest question, a pause before answering.

One thing to try: In one conversation this week, ask a second question before you offer any advice.

WHERE WE HAVE BEEN THIS WEEK

- **Monday** (managers) covered **The Coaching Moment**: Spotting the coaching moment hiding inside the status conversation [recap or catch up](#)
- **Tuesday** (all staff) covered **The Growth Record**: Capturing your development goals and career-conversation notes in Oracle [recap or catch up](#)

WHAT IS COMING

- **Thursday** brings **The Second Channel**: Empathy at work: hearing what isn't said [details and sign-up](#)
- **The in-person workshop** this month is **The Practicum**, 90 minutes with a navigator, hands on in the room. Watch your invite for the date. Sign up: [\[sign-up link\]](#)

Change fatigue is real, and it has a pace

This month's theme: Spot AI-Exposed Work

SAY THIS

- Change fatigue is not resistance. It is what happens when changes arrive faster than people can absorb them, and it shows up as flat energy rather than open objection.
- Adoption goes better in small, finished pieces. One change that lands beats three that are half-installed.
- Naming the fatigue out loud costs nothing and takes a surprising amount of pressure out of a team.

One thing to try: Ask your team, or yourself, which change is still only half-landed. Finish that one before starting another.

WHERE WE HAVE BEEN THIS WEEK

- **Monday** (managers) covered **The Exposure Map**: Walking your team's work through an AI-exposure lens [recap or catch up](#)
- **Tuesday** (all staff) covered **The Task Sort**: Task-decomposition: automate, augment, or leave alone [recap or catch up](#)

WHAT IS COMING

- **Thursday** brings **The Hype Filter**: Softskill · Critical thinking: sorting hype from value [details and sign-up](#)
- **The in-person workshop** this month is **The Team Grid**, 90 minutes with a navigator, hands on in the room. Watch your invite for the date. Sign up: [\[sign-up link\]](#)

Receiving feedback without emptying the tank

This month's theme: Measured Leader Behavior

SAY THIS

- Feedback lands hardest when it feels like a verdict on who you are rather than information about something you did.
- You do not have to accept or reject it in the room. Thank the person, sit with it, and decide later what to do with it.
- One adjustment is a complete response. Trying to fix everything at once is how people end up avoiding feedback altogether.

One thing to try: The next time you get feedback, say thank you and write it down. Choose your one adjustment tomorrow, not in the moment.

WHERE WE HAVE BEEN THIS WEEK

- **Monday** (managers) covered **Your Own Evidence**: Evidence of the manager standard: what gets measured [recap or catch up](#)
- **Tuesday** (all staff) covered **Your Own Signal**: Pulse and 360 tooling: reading your own signal [recap or catch up](#)

WHAT IS COMING

- **Thursday** brings **The Blind Spot**: Self-awareness: closing your blind spots [details and sign-up](#)
- **The in-person workshop** this month is **The Practice Room**, 90 minutes with a navigator, hands on in the room. Watch your invite for the date. Sign up: [\[sign-up link\]](#)

Recovery before the next stretch

This month's theme: From Insight to Action

SAY THIS

- Rest is not what happens when the work runs out. Planned recovery is what makes the next stretch of work possible.
- Closing a season properly means naming what actually got done, not just what is still open.
- The habits from this year survive a break. They do not survive being carried at full speed indefinitely.

One thing to try: Write down one thing you finished this year that you never marked as finished. Then take the break you have been deferring.

WHERE WE HAVE BEEN THIS WEEK

- **Monday** (managers) covered **The Four Moves**: Translating AI insights into workforce moves [recap or catch up](#)
- **Tuesday** (all staff) covered **The 90-Day Plan**: Building a 90-day AI action plan [recap or catch up](#)

WHAT IS COMING

- **Thursday** brings **Enough to Move**: Decisiveness: moving from data to move [details and sign-up](#)
- **The in-person workshop** this month is **The Action Lab**, 90 minutes with a navigator, hands on in the room. Watch your invite for the date. Sign up: [\[sign-up link\]](#)